DETACHMENT — HORUS HERESY (30K)

BETTER PART OF VALOUR

NIGHT LORDS (HH, TRAITOR) | WARHAMMER 40,000 | 11TH EDITION

Better Part of Valour is a fully homebrew Detachment for the Night Lords (VIII Legion) faction — a Horus Heresy-era Traitor Legion detachment adapted to the Warhammer 40,000 11th-edition Detachment framework, built from the real HH3e Night Lords Rite of War data. Formatted to match the No Figure Left Behind Combat Patrol archive.

FACTION ABILITY

A TALENT FOR MURDER

The VIII Legion was built for one purpose: to find the weakness terror leaves behind, and open it wider. Each time a model in a friendly Night Lords unit makes a melee attack that targets a Battle-shocked unit, add 1 to the Hit roll.

DETACHMENT RULE

BETTER PART OF VALOUR

Detachment Points: To use this detachment you must spend 1 DP.

No Night Lords captain ever mistook cowardice for the tactical retreat, and no Night Lords captain was ever ashamed to order one. Each time an enemy unit declares a charge that targets a friendly Night Lords unit, you can select that Night Lords unit to immediately make a Fall Back move, as if it were your Movement phase. If you do, that Night Lords unit is removed as an eligible target of that Charge move (any other targets of the same Charge move are unaffected), and that Night Lords unit does not suffer any of the normal penalties for having Fallen Back this turn.

FORCE DISPOSITIONS

This detachment has access to the following Force Disposition: Disruption.

DETACHMENT COMPOSITION

Included: All homebrew Night Lords (HH) roster units (Konrad Curze, Sevatar, Contekar Terminator Squad, Night Raptor Squad, Terror Squad, Atramentar Flay-clade, Inductii Squad), and any homebrew Legiones Astartes (HH) unit from the generic Space Marines (HH) roster given the Night Lords Trait.

Excluded: Any other Legion's Primarch or named characters. Non-Legiones-Astartes allies, per standard HH3e Legion-purity convention.

ENHANCEMENTS

TERROR TACTICIAN — *Character model only*

Each time an enemy unit within 6" of the bearer takes a Battle-shock test, subtract 1 from that test (in addition to any other modifiers).

NIGHT-STALKER'S CLOAK — *Character model only*

The bearer has the [STEALTH] ability.

RELIC OF NOSTRAMO — *Character model only*

Melee weapons equipped by the bearer have the [LETHAL HITS] ability.

MASTER OF THE FIRST WAVE — *Character model only*

Each time the bearer's unit is set up on the battlefield using the Deep Strike ability, until the end of that phase, models in that unit have the [FEEL NO PAIN 5+] ability.

STRATAGEMS

NOSTRAMAN COURAGE **1CP**
Night Lords — Battle Tactic Stratagem

When: Fight phase, after an enemy unit selects a friendly Night Lords Character model as the target of one or more of its attacks.

Target: That Character model's unit.

Effect: You can select a different, non-Character model in that unit to be allocated those attacks instead, provided that model is within Engagement Range of the attacking model.

FIRST TO THE KILL **1CP**
Night Lords — Strategic Ploy Stratagem

When: Your Charge phase.

Target: One friendly Night Lords unit that made a Charge move this phase.

Effect: Until the end of the turn, that unit has the [FIGHTS FIRST] ability.

MERCILESS SPITE **1CP**
Night Lords — Epic Deed Stratagem

When: Fight phase, just after a friendly Night Lords Character model is destroyed, before it is removed from play.

Target: That model.

Effect: If that model has not already fought this phase, it can fight once, using its normal characteristics, before being removed as a casualty.

HUNT THE BROKEN **1CP**
Night Lords — Battle Tactic Stratagem

When: Your opponent's Command phase, just after an enemy unit fails a Battle-shock test.

Target: One friendly Night Lords unit within 12" of that enemy unit.

Effect: Until the start of your next turn, ranged weapons equipped by models in that Night Lords unit have the [LETHAL HITS] ability when targeting that enemy unit.

VANISH INTO THE DARK **2CP**
Night Lords — Strategic Ploy Stratagem

When: Your opponent's Shooting phase, just after a friendly Night Lords unit is selected as the target of a ranged attack.

Target: That Night Lords unit.

Effect: Until the end of the phase, that unit has the Benefit of Cover, and any ability that ignores the Benefit of Cover does not apply to it.

DECAPITATION STRIKE **2CP**
Night Lords — Battle Tactic Stratagem

When: Fight phase, when a friendly Night Lords unit is chosen to fight.

Target: That unit.

Effect: Until the end of the phase, that unit's melee weapons have the [PRECISION] ability.

DESIGNER'S NOTE

Homebrew — HH3e (2026) Night Lords Legion Rite of War → 11e conversion. Built from the real HH3e Rite of War data in `Night Lords.json`, which has one baseline rite with three named pieces: Legion Tactica "A Talent for Murder" (real: +1 Weapon Skill when Locked in Combat against Units with any Tactical Status — used here as the army-wide Faction Ability, translated as a +1 to-hit bonus against Battle-shocked units, since Battle-shock is 11e's closest analogue to HH3e's family of negative Tactical Statuses), Gambit "Nostraman Courage" (real: a Challenge-only ability letting the Controlling Player swap out the Model fighting a Challenge for a different Model in the Unit — translated into the Nostraman Courage Stratagem as a "protect the Character" wound-redirection effect, since 11e has no Challenge sub-system to swap combatants within), and Advanced Reaction "Better Part of Valour" (real: a Reaction Point-costed ability letting a Night-Lords-only Unit Fall Back when charged without gaining the Routed status) — promoted to the Detachment Rule itself, matching how every other Legion's flagship real mechanic has anchored its own detachment; this is a deliberately fitting flagship for the Legion built entirely around raid-and-vanish terror tactics rather than a stand-and-hold identity. First to the Kill, Merciless Spite, Hunt the Broken, Vanish into the Dark, and Decapitation Strike are original stratagems filling out the standard six (Merciless Spite mirrors the "fight from beyond death" Epic Deed pattern already established for other Legions); Enhancements are original, themed around the Legion's fear-doctrine and first-wave-infiltration identity.